UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND, JOHANNESBURG

Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical)
FWA Registered No IRB 00001223

SECRETARIAT: Suite 189, Private Bag x2600, Houghton 2041, South Africa Tel: +27-11-274 9200 Fax: +27-11-274 9281

Prof MF Chersich,

EMAILED

Wits RHI Head Quarters
Hillbrow Health Precinct
22 Esselen Street
Hillbrow
2001

26 October 2023

Email: mchersich@wrhi.ac.za

Dear Prof Chersich,

PROTOCOL: HEAT002 - INNOVATIVE MACHINE LEARNING AND MULTI-SOURCE DATA ANALYSIS TOWARDS DEVELOPMENT OF AN URBAN HEAT-HEALTH EARLY WARNING SYSTEM FOR AFRICAN CITIES

ETHICS REFERENCE NO: 220606

RE : APPROVAL FOR SECONDARY DATA ANALYSIS

We acknowledge receipt of your letter dated 12 October 2023 with the following documentation pertaining to the above-captioned study.

Amendment Date:	15-Sep-23	Amendment Version:	Protocol Version 2.0
Amendment Number:		Received Date:	12-Oct-23

The following has been approved by the Wits Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical):

* HEAT002 Protocol, Version 2.0 dated 15 September 2023
* Letter of Amendment #1 dated 13 September 2023

PLEASE NOTE FOR YOUR URGENT ATTENTION: THE FOLLOWING IS NOT APPROVED:

* The Informed Consent Waiver #1 dated 14 September 2023 is not approved.

The Wits HREC (Medical) cannot approve an Informed Consent waiver on a broad basis, approval must be requested on an individual basis. This will also depend on each studies consent form and what the participant for each study had agreed to. If the participant did not consent to this, then re-consent would be required.

In addition, the studies that were approved in Cote d'Ivoire would require approval from their own ethics committee and appropriate Regulatory Authority in that country. Wits HREC (Medical) has no jurisdiction to approve on behalf of these studies.

Ethics Approval Date: 26 October 2023

The University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee Approval Granted for the above mentioned study is valid for five years. Where required by Sponsor to have approval on a more frequent basis it remains the responsibility of the Sponsor and Investigator to apply for continuing review and approval, or for the duration of the study.

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1. THIS APPROVAL IS SUBJECT TO THE FOLLOWING PROVISOS:

* A copy of the SAHPRA Approval and/or SAHPRA Notification letter must be submitted to the Ethics Regulatory Office Secretariat before the study commences / or where an Amendment may be implemented (IF SAHPRA APPROVAL / NOTIFICATION IS APPLICABLE). It remains the responsibility of the Principal Investigator and/or Sponsor to ensure that the relevant approvals are in place.

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* The study is conducted according to the protocol submitted to the University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee. Any amendments to the protocol must first be submitted to the Human Research Ethics Committee for approval.

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* During the study, the University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee is informed immediately of :

- Any Unexpected Serious Adverse Events or Unexpected Adverse Drug Reactions, which, in the Investigator and/or the Sponsor's opinion are suspected to be related to the study drug. (Refer to POL-IEC–001 and SOP-IEC–005, Item 3.4).
- Any data received during the study which, may cast doubt on the validity of the continuation of the study .

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* The University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee is notified of any decision to discontinue the study and the reason stated.

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* The Investigators authorised by this approval participate in this study. Additional Investigators shall be submitted to the University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee for approval prior to their participation in the study.

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* In the event of an authorised Investigator ceasing to participate in the study, the University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee must be informed and the reason for such cessation given.

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2. PRINCIPLES OF INFORMED CONSENT:

* The University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee requires that in all studies, the Principles of Informed Consent are adhered to. This applies to volunteers as well as patients.

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3. PROGRESS REPORTS:

* The University of the Witwatersrand, Human Research Ethics Committee requests that the SAHPRA Progress Reports be submitted twice a year either in March and September or six monthly from start of study to the HREC Secretariat Office - email: EthicsRegulatory@witshealth.co.za and a report of the final results, at the conclusion of the study. (IF APPLICABLE)

4. REIMBURSEMENT TO PATIENTS FOR TRANSPORT:

* The Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical) is in agreement that reimbursement per visit is according to the South African Health Products Regulatory Authority and that reimbursement should be appropriate according to the situation.

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5. TRANSPORT AND STORAGE OF BLOOD AND TISSUE SAMPLES IN SOUTH AFRICA:

* If blood specimens are to be stored for future analysis and is planned that such analysis will be done outside Wits, then the blood must be stored at a facility in South Africa agreed with the relevant IRB, with release of sub-samples only once projects have been approved by the local Research Ethics Committee applicable to where the analysis will be done as well as by the Wits Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical).

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6. GENETIC TESTING

* The Human Research Ethics Committee: Medical; will not approve open-ended genetic testing as this does not fit the Human Research Ethics Committee criteria.

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7. GOOD CLINICAL PRACTICE

The South African Department of Health, South African Health Products Regulatory Authority requires Good Clinical Practice (GCP) Training for all Investigators and that GCP training be renewed every three (3) years.

The GCP training must be based on the South African Good Clinical Practice: Clinical Trial Guidelines. Third Edition (SA GCP 2020)

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The above has been noted for the Ethics Committee information and records.

KINDLY FORWARD TO THE RELEVANT INVESTIGATORS / CRA / STUDY CO-ORDINATORS

Regards,

PROF PAUL RUFF
For and on behalf of the Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical)

Processed by: Thashin Reddy - Tel: 011 274 3353